

Fly GACA — Phase 0 Status Report

SECTION 06-operations-it TYPE report STATUS **active** OWNER Captain Adel Madkhali

UPDATED 2026-08-19

[!NOTE] **Superseded 2026-08-19 — retained as a record, not corrected.** This document captured the position as it stood on its own date. The price card, the B2B pricing model and the platform architecture have all changed since: see [01-governance/decision-log.md](#) **DEC-011** and [03-finance/monetization.md](#) for what is current. Nothing below has been edited — its value is that it records what was decided or observed at the time, including the parts that later turned out to be wrong.

Date: 23 May 2026 **Owner:** Captain Adel Madkhali **Covers:** Progress on Phase 0 — Foundations.

Point-in-time snapshot. This report reflects the state on 23 May 2026 and is ~3+ weeks old as of 2026-06-16. It is kept as a historical record — for current status see [../00-strategy/phase0.md](#). **TODO(owner):** confirm whether a fresh status report is due.

Summary

Phase 0 is well underway. The technical foundations are largely in place — the repository is scaffolded, the Firebase backend exists with its database correctly configured in the Dammam region, and the VPS pipeline box is provisioned and being hardened. The legal track (redistribution rights and the "Fly GACA" name) has had its desk research completed and now needs a Saudi IP lawyer. The legal entity registration has not yet started.

Phase 0 workstreams at a glance

ID	Workstream	Status
P0-1	Resolve redistribution rights	In progress — desk research done; lawyer pending
P0-2	Domain canonicalization + name lock	In progress — research done; decision + lawyer pending
P0-3	Register the legal entity	Not started
P0-4	Create the repository	In progress — scaffolded locally; GitHub push pending
P0-5	Create the Firebase project	Done
P0-6	Set up the VPS pipeline box	In progress — provisioned; hardening underway

The live, detailed checklist lives in the repository at [fLygaca/phase0.md](#).

Research findings

P0-1 — Redistribution rights (the launch-blocker)

Desk research is encouraging. Saudi copyright law — both the current 2003 law (Article 4) and the new law that takes effect 12 August 2026 — excludes official regulations and official documents from copyright protection. GACAR parts fall squarely inside that exclusion, so rehosting them is very likely permissible; the Saudi AIP and GACA advisory circulars probably so. The new 2026 law also adds an AI exception that helps the Captain Adel corpus, though its precise scope awaits SAIP's implementing regulations. GACA's own website terms only permit personal / non-commercial use, so the case for commercial rehosting rests on the copyright-law exclusion, not on GACA's site licence. **A Saudi IP lawyer must confirm this against the new law before any corpus rehosting.** Zero-risk interim option: launch Phase 1 as a deep-linking index to GACA's own copies, then rehost once cleared.

P0-2 — Domain and the "Fly GACA" name

The domain is straightforward — keep **flygaca.com** as canonical (it is owned and `.com` has no eligibility rules); `flygaca.sa` would need the legal entity first and may be queried by SaudiNIC because it contains "gaca". The name itself is the real risk: Saudi trademark law prohibits registering marks that use a government authority's designation, and SAIP can refuse marks with misleading components. "Fly GACA" may be unregistrable as a trademark, and a disclaimer reduces but does not cure that exposure. The lawyer should weigh three paths: keep "Fly GACA" with prominent disclaimers; demote it to a descriptive tagline and register a different primary mark; or rebrand. "Captain Adel" as a brand is unaffected. Note: an existing `github.com/FlyGACA` org with a `Library` repo should be reconciled.

Both findings are desk research, not legal advice.

What's been built

Repository (P0-4)

The full repository structure has been scaffolded locally in the workspace, at `flygaca/`. It contains the folder tree from the briefing (`assets`, `assistant`, `build_finance`, `evals`, `functions/rag`, `library/PDFs`, `legal`, `office`, `tests`, `.github`), eleven top-level HTML page placeholders with the unofficial-status disclaimer baked into each, a README, `.gitignore`, a CI workflow, issue and PR templates, and a Dependabot config. The PR template carries a legal/corpus checklist. Git is initialised with an initial commit. **Outstanding:** create the private `github.com/iflygaca/flygaca` repository and push; turn on branch protection for `main`.

Firebase (P0-5 — done)

The Firebase project exists and its database is correctly configured.

- **Project ID:** `flygaca-com`

- **Owner Google account:** flygaca@gmail.com
- **Web app:** registered as "Fly GACA"; the web config is saved in the repo at `assets/js/firebase-config.js` (these values are public-safe by design).
- **Cloud Firestore:** database `(default)`, **Standard edition**, Native mode, region **me-central2 (Dammam)** — keeps data inside the Kingdom for PDPL.
- **Billing:** Spark (free) plan for now.

Along the way a duplicate Google Cloud project — `fly-gaca-495116` (display name "Fly-GACA") — was created by accident; it is empty and unused, and is flagged for deletion later. The first Firestore database was mistakenly created as Enterprise edition; it was deleted and recreated correctly as Standard `(default)`.

Deferred to their proper phases: enabling Authentication (Phase 3), registering App Check (Phase 2/3), Hosting setup (Phase 1 deploy), and the Blaze plan upgrade (start of Phase 2 — needs a payment card). The data-residency of Gemini / Vertex AI inference still needs to be verified before Phase 2.

VPS (P0-6 — in progress)

The pipeline box is provisioned and being hardened.

- **Provider / plan:** Hostinger **KVM 2** (2 vCPU / 8 GB RAM / 100 GB NVMe)
- **IP:** 72.62.20.20 — **hostname:** `srv1209075.hstgr.cloud`
- **OS:** Ubuntu **24.04 LTS** (reinstalled — it had been provisioned on the non-LTS 25.10)
- **Region:** not yet confirmed (Hostinger has no Middle East datacenter; a Europe location is expected)
- **Access:** SSH key-based login works; a non-root admin user `adel` has been created with sudo rights, the SSH key, and a password.
- **Firewall:** the Hostinger panel firewall's catch-all "Drop" rule was removed to unblock SSH; a proper firewall (`ufw`) will be configured on the box during hardening.
- **Data boundary (PDPL):** the VPS is outside Saudi Arabia, so it handles **public data only** — corpus ingestion, RAG indexing, the eval harness, staging builds. No personal data ever touches it; that all stays in the Kingdom (Firestore me-central2 / Cloud Functions).

Outstanding on the VPS: finish hardening (lock down SSH, `ufw`, fail2ban), update the OS, install Python 3.11 / Node.js 20 / git, and confirm the region.

Key facts

Item	Value
Firebase project ID	flygaca-com
Google account	flygaca@gmail.com
Firestore	(default), Standard, Native, me-central2 (Dammam)

Item	Value
Duplicate project to delete	fly-gaca-495116
VPS provider / plan	Hostinger KVM 2
VPS IP / hostname	72.62.20.20 / srv1209075.hstgr.cloud
VPS OS	Ubuntu 24.04 LTS
VPS admin user	adel (sudo)
Canonical domain	flygaca.com
Repository	flygaca/ (local; GitHub push pending)

Decisions made this session

- The Phase 0 tracker is kept as Markdown (`phase0.md`) inside the repository.
- The repository is scaffolded inside the workspace folder as `flygaca/`.
- Firebase: keep project `flygaca-com` (not the accidental duplicate); Firestore recreated as Standard edition (`default`) in me-central2.
- VPS: a fresh Hostinger KVM 2 box; OS reinstalled to Ubuntu 24.04 LTS; the VPS is a public-data-only pipeline box.
- The Hostinger panel firewall is being dropped in favour of `ufw` on the box.

Open items and risks

- **Launch-blocker (P0-1):** redistribution rights need a Saudi IP lawyer's confirmation.
- **Name risk (P0-2):** "Fly GACA" may be unregistrable as a trademark — lawyer decision needed.
- The legal entity (P0-3) is not started; it needs the final name locked first.
- The GitHub repository is not yet created or pushed.
- The duplicate Firebase project `fly-gaca-495116` should be deleted.
- Gemini / Vertex AI inference data-residency is unverified.

Next steps

Immediate — finishing P0-6 (VPS):

1. Test `ssh adel@72.62.20.20` and `sudo whoami` from the Mac — confirm key login and sudo for `adel`.
2. Lock down SSH — disable root login and password authentication.
3. Configure `ufw` and install fail2ban.
4. Update the OS.

5. Install Python 3.11, Node.js 20 and git.

6. Confirm and record the VPS region.

Then:

- Create the `github.com/iflygaca/flygaca` repository and push (finishes P0-4).
- Brief a Saudi IP lawyer on P0-1 and P0-2 together.
- Begin P0-3 (legal entity) once the name is locked.
- Delete the duplicate Firebase project `fly-gaca-495116`.